

What do admissions officers look for in recommendations?/Goals of LORs.

- How does the student interact with faculty?
- How does the student interact with peers?
- How does the student engage in the learning process?
- How has the student impacted the class?
- How does the student face obstacles and setbacks?
- How does the student compare to peers and other students throughout the teacher's career?

Teacher LOR and Classroom context

Paragraph 1

Introduce yourself:

- How long have you been teaching and in what context.
- Additional roles you have known the student
- Introduce the student:
- How long have you taught the student
- A general thesis of the student

Q1: Student engagement in the learning process

- Is the student intellectually curious?
- Does the student meet/exceed classroom requirements?
- Does the student make connections across topics/disciplines?
- How do you imagine the student learning in college?

Q2: Peer interaction

- Does the student work well in groups?
- Does the student assist others who may be struggling?
- Is the student respectful of other students' opinions?

Q3: Impact to classroom

- Does the student frequently lead discussions?
- Does the student make less frequent but meaningful contributions?
- How do you imagine the student impacting a college class?

Q4: Reaction to setback/Growth mindset

- Has the student faced any challenge in your classroom? How did the student respond?
- Does the student actively seek feedback or input in assignments or ideas?
- For students with struggles, what flashes of potential or improvement have you noticed?

It is very important that you include growth in your LORs.

Q5: Faculty interaction

- How does the student interact with you on a daily basis?
- Does the student reach out for additional help, support or information?

- How do you envision the student's interaction with professors?

Q6: Comparison with peers & others throughout your career

- What stands out more for this student compared to others?
- Is the student more motivated/intellectually engaged than other students? How? Why?
- Is this student one of the most memorable you've taught? Why?
- Has this student made you a better teacher?

Counsellor LOR

Goals:

- Personal growth of the student
- Role of the student within the school community
- What makes this student stand out among the rest

Paragraph 1

Introduce yourself:

- How long have you been a counsellor?
- How many students do you work with?

Introduce the school:

- Anything important to note about the school?

Introduce the student:

- How long have you known the student?
- A general thesis of the student

Q1: Is the student intellectually curious?

- Has the student taken a more challenging curriculum than other students?
- Have they shown significant academic growth throughout high school?
- How do you imagine the student in a college/university classroom?
- Does the student reach out for additional help, support or information?

Q2: How has the student impacted the community?

- Is the student a role model/leader in the community? How? What are some of their initiatives?
- Has the student made your school a better place?
- Will your school be different when the student graduates?
- How do you imagine the student impacting the campus community?

Q3: Peer interaction

Q4: Reaction to setback

Q5: Is there anything else admissions should know? e.g. school scholarships, student's background etc.

Strengths

- Be brief and avoid unnecessary information
- Formal tone

- Most of the letter should be focused on academics
- Be very specific. As you answer those questions, tell the story of how those events were.
- Make the letter sound honest. Give relevant examples to support your praises

Avoid

- Generic praises
- Lack of specificity
- Summarising resume (activities) and transcript
- Hollow adjectives
- Informal tone. Make sure somebody goes through your LORs before submitting.

